

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What's taking so long?



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about manners and customs.
- I can talk about life experiences.
- I can express possibility or certainty.

Ask your partner:

- What stereotypes do you know about people from other countries?
- Are you usually on time or late? Why?





Let's Explore!

Peter's date is late. Why is that **bugging*** him so much?

* When something "bugs" you, you find it annoying.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Where can Rosa be? She told me she would meet me here at 7, and it's already 7:30. We may not make the beginning of the baseball game if she is too late. She might be stuck in traffic, who knows? I'm sure that she must have a good reason for not being on time. I can't stand it when people aren't punctual!
- Rosa:** Peter! Nice to see you!
- Peter:** Hi Rosa, I'm happy to finally see you, too.
- Rosa:** What's wrong? You sound upset.
- Peter:** It's nothing ... Well, it's just that I had bought these tickets for the game before we decided to meet in this restaurant. We may not make it for the beginning now.
- Rosa:** Oh, I'm sorry, Peter. I must have lost track of the time. I had thought about setting up my alarm, but I forgot. I usually don't look at my watch, either.
- Peter:** So, the stereotypes about Italians are true?
- Rosa:** You may be right. I hadn't noticed how we Italians cut in line all the time until I came to the States. We're not very good at queuing up, I guess.
- Peter:** I suppose you could make an effort.
- Rosa:** We're too busy being affectionate for that!
- Peter:** That's true, even though some people here may think that you're too touchy-feely.
- Rosa:** Maybe we could order something now, what do you think?





Let's Practice!

Rosa's life experiences are very interesting.

Instructions: Use the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

1. I recently _____ to Canada, and it's been amazing!
2. I _____ noticed how we Italians cut in line all the time until I came to the States.
3. I _____ track of the time, that happens to me all the time.
4. I _____ about setting up my alarm, but I forgot. I usually don't look at my watch.
5. I _____ to make an effort in order to fit in this society. It must be annoying for you.

Word bank

- decided
- moved
- hadn't
- had thought
- must have lost



Let's Practice!

Different manners and customs make new interesting cultures!

Instructions: Proofread the paragraph. Underline the incorrect words. Rewrite the paragraph. Use capital letters where necessary. Read the paragraph aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

That's the way we brazilians are, you know? And, the thing is that I have never noticed it. For example, I didn't notice how we Italians cut in line all the time until I came to the States. We're not very good at queuing up, I guess. It's like it did happen to me today, sorry about it but I may have lost track of the time. I thought about setting up my alarm, but I forgot. I usually don't look at my watch, either.





Extension Activity

My Personal Timeline

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On a blank piece of paper, create a timeline of your life.
- Include all of the most important events (e.g. moves, graduations, jobs, vacations).
- Listen as your partner presents their timeline, ask at least five follow-up questions (e.g. "Had you ever been to Cuba before?").
- Present your timeline and answer your partner's follow-up questions.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I create a timeline of past events.

☐☐

I present a past narrative.

☐☐

I ask questions about the past.

☐☐

I respond to questions about the past.

☐☐

Target Words

- **punctual** (adjective): used to describe a person who is always on time
e.g. I can't stand it when people aren't punctual!
- **to lose track of** (expression): to fail to keep informed or aware of something
e.g. I must have lost track of the time.
- **to queue up** (verb): to form a line; to stand in line
e.g. We're not very good at queuing up.
- **to cut (in line)** (verb): to enter a line without queuing
e.g. I hadn't noticed how we Italians cut in line all the time.
- **affectionate** (adjective): used to describe a person who easily reveals their feelings or emotions
e.g. We're too busy being affectionate for that!
- **touchy-feely** (adjective): used to describe a person who openly displays their emotions and affections
e.g. Some people here may think that you're too touchy-feely.





Learning Points

Simple Past vs Past Perfect

You use the Past Perfect tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

You use the Simple Past to talk about a finished action that happened at a specific time in the past.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the Past Perfect tense.

The structure of the Past Perfect is:

Subject + had + past participle

*I **had thought** about setting up my alarm, but I forgot.*

Which event happened *first*? I thought about setting up the alarm.

Which event happened *later*? I forgot.

You use the Past Perfect tense (not Simple Past) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

Example:

I hadn't noticed how we Italians cut in line all the time until I came to the States.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about the action that happened after that prior action in the Past Perfect tense.

Examples:

- *I had bought these tickets for the game before we decided to meet in this restaurant.*





Learning Points

Modals for Possibility and Certainty

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty.

You can use modals with the Present Perfect to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context.

Example:

*I **must have** lost track of the time.*

Must = it's very likely

Must not / Could not / Can't = it's not possible

May / Might / Can / Could = it's possible

May not / Might not = it's possible this is not true

Modal	Meaning
<i>She must have a good reason for not being on time.</i>	It's very likely she has a good reason.
<i>I can't stand it when people aren't punctual!</i>	It is not possible for me to accept.
<i>We could miss the beginning of the baseball game.</i>	It's possible to miss the beginning.
<i>We may not make it for the beginning now.</i>	It's not likely that we can make it for the beginning.

